

correspondence – earlier sent as printed notes and books through snail mail, but with multimedia coming into the picture, this turned into a combination of print and digital media (Cassettes, CDs, DVDs). In today's connected age, these courses are delivered through interactive media.



Books v.s digital gyan?

It was thought that with e-learning picking up momentum, distance learning would altogether vanish, but that hasn't been the case. In fact, distance learning has evolved and adapted to stay relevant in changing times, and due to some important factors remains irreplaceable.

What is E-Learning?

This term has often been used interchangeably with distance learning. Although they overlap in plenty of areas now, there are subtle

differences between the two. E-learning is relatively new and technology dependent. The course material is available online and can be accessed from anywhere, provided you have an internet connection. The access device could include a computer, tablet or even a smartphone.

Difference between Distance Learning and E-Learning

Cost

Since distance learning courses are modelled after university courses and help you earn a degree at the end of the course (after giving the examination), these involve a cost. However, the charges are definitely much lower than what you would have paid if attending full-time.

As we've seen in the earlier chapters, e-learning courses are being offered free of cost by many prestigious institutes around the world. If you sign up for a certificate course however, a small fee is required to be paid. At the end of such a course, you'll be given a certificate (by the university whose course you're taking) stating that you have undertaken the course.